

this can be easily corrected digitally, in many cases, especially in landscapes, this causes an unnatural colouration.

Once the images are taken, copy them to your computer, and you are ready to make the actual panorama. There are many free and commercial software for creating panoramas available on the internet. Panoramic tools is widely used, but requires a front-end like PTGUI. Another software for panoramas is Hugin. However, in our experience, nothing works out as efficiently as good old Photoshop. It can automatically handle difficult subject matter as leaves, grass and clouds, correcting the brightness errors in the photograph and churn out decent looking panoramas. In Photoshop CS3, go to File > Automate > Photomerge, select the files to be made into a panorama, choose the “auto” option as your Layout and click on ok. Photoshop will run a script and then automatically match up the images and generate a multilayered file. Flatten the layers, crop off the excess areas and save the file, and your panorama is ready. Reduce the image dimensions by half and slash the quality down to 70 to upload a panorama on the internet if you don’t want to use up too much space.

Once a complete 360-degree panorama is made, you can use the image to create a planet panorama like the one here. You have to make sure that the right hand side of the image matches up with the left hand side of the image perfectly for this to work. Make sure that the brightness and contrast of the two areas also match up. To save disk space, reduce the image dimensions by half before proceeding. Also, look at the width of your photograph in pixels, and create a new blank square image with the same dimensions as the width. The image should be as high as it is wide, or the panorama will not work. Then, drag the panorama onto this image, and stretch it so that it occupies the entire height of the image. Now go to Filter > Distort > Polar Co-ordinates and select “Rectangular to Polar”, and your planet panorama is ready. You can alternatively make a cylindrical panorama by leaving a band of white space at the bottom of the image, and following the same procedure.